The Occupied Territories became a cancer in the Israeli body politic and, even more so, in Israeli society. As my friend Jacob Fried recently wrote to me: “Israel did not annex the territories; the territories annexed Israel.”

Tuesday, January 24

Could all this end up in some kind of half-baked compromise whereby Netanyahu, in order to avoid international difficulties and too much internal turmoil, will rein in his most extreme and unreliable allies? Yesterday he traveled to Amman to promise King Abdullah that the status quo on Temple Mount would remain unchanged. It seems that he also refused to order the evacuation of a Bedouin village in the south of Jerusalem, Khan al-Ahmar, which for some time now has been a demand of the right. Such a compromise would be a logical endgame if our Houdini wasn’t under three indictments and ready to take every political risk to avoid the probable outcome.

The governor of the Bank of Israel, Amir Yaron, warns Netanyahu of the dangerous international consequences for the country’s economy if the judicial reform is implemented. According to the news, the PM dismissed the warning.

In the meantime, the ultrareligious Knesset members of Torah Judaism proceed with an initiative of their own: they introduce a bill preventing hospitals from bringing in hametz food (produced by leavened grains) during this coming Passover. And the whole coalition tries to insert new clauses into the Law of Return: for Jews only, not, for example, for grandchildren of mixed marriages, quarter Jews. It reminds them of nothing? Half Jewish, Quarter Jews, *Mischlinge ersten Grades*, *Mischlinge zweiten Grades*. What a shame!

Wednesday, January 25